



NEXT CHAPTER @ SMITH PUBLIC LIBRARY

Welcome to Your Path Forward

Session 1 — Orientation & Getting Started

Monday Evenings • 6:00–8:00 PM • Library Conference Room

You're in the Right Place



Turn to someone near you and share:

- 1 Your first name
- 2 One thing you're hoping to get out of this program
- 3 One thing that makes you nervous about it (we've all got one!)

You are not the only adult in this room starting over. Every single person here made the same call you did — to show up on a Monday night and take this on. That already puts you ahead.



Michelle Bellamy

Your Instructor

Meet Your Instructor

- MS ITM Program Director & instructor at UT Dallas's business school
- Background across Goldman Sachs, EY, Google, IBM, and more
- Loves helping adults find their footing in a classroom again — no judgment, no pressure
- Reachable every week at office hours, and by email anytime between sessions

This Isn't School

A few ground rules for how we'll think about this together



Progress, not perfection

Every practice test, every session — you're building, not being graded on where you are today.



Mistakes are data

A wrong answer just tells us exactly what to work on next. That's useful, not shameful.



You set the pace that works for your life

Job, kids, other responsibilities — we'll work with your reality, not against it.

How This Program Works



Monday Class

2 hours, in person, every week — this is our core time together.



Thursday Office Hours

1 hour, optional, virtual — drop in with questions, no pressure.



Take-Home Practice

Short, self-paced online practice between sessions — 5-10 minutes.

What's on the GED?

Four subjects. We'll cover every one of them, in order, this year.



Mathematical Reasoning



Reasoning Through Language Arts



Science



Social Studies

Your 30-Week Journey

September through May, following the school calendar

We are here →



Each subject block ends with an official practice checkpoint — that's how we know when you're ready for the real test.

Tonight's Agenda

1

Welcome & introductions

15 min

2

How this program works

20 min

3

Meet the GED test format

15 min

4

GED Ready diagnostic (all 4 subjects)

60 min

5

Wrap-up & what to expect next week

10 min



What is “GED Ready”?

It's a practice test — not the real thing.

Tonight's diagnostic just tells us where you're starting from. It doesn't count toward anything, go on your record, or cost you anything if you don't finish every question.

Think of it as a starting line, not a test you can fail. We'll use tonight's results to know exactly where to focus — for you individually, and for the group.

A Sneak Peek at the Test Format

The GED is taken on a computer. Here are the main question styles you'll see:



Multiple Choice

Click the best answer from a list.



Drag & Drop

Drag items into the correct order or category.



Fill in the Blank

Type a short answer or number directly.



Highlight in Text

Click and select the part of a passage that answers the question.

You Won't Do This Alone



Classmates

Everyone here is on the same road — lean on each other.



Thursday Office Hours

Optional, virtual, 1 hour a week — come with questions, big or small.



Email & Check-ins

I'm reachable between sessions — don't sit stuck on something all week.

A Few Housekeeping Items



Attendance

Try to miss no more than 1 class per subject block — it keeps you eligible for free official practice tests.



Communication

I'll email reminders and updates weekly — please keep an eye on your inbox.



Materials

Bring a notebook and something to write with. Everything else is provided.



Let's Get Started!

Time for the GED Ready diagnostic — take your time, do your best, and remember: this doesn't count against you.



Great First Night.

See you next Monday — we'll dig into your results and start Math.

Before next week:

Check your email for your diagnostic results and try the take-home practice tool — just 10 minutes.